

INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Professional Development

ACCOUNTING APPLICATIONS SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Accurate – Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Discuss professional designations for accountants (e.g., CPA, CMA, CIA, CFE, etc.).
2. Identify career opportunities in accounting.
3. Explain the roles and responsibilities of accounting professionals.
4. Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.
5. Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of a senior accountant at HALVERSON MANUFACTURING, a company that makes kitchen appliances. A staff accountant (judge) wants your advice on earning a professional designation.

The staff accountant (judge) has worked at HALVERSON for two years, earns $62,000 a year, and is deciding between the Certified Public Accountant (CPA) and the Certified Management Accountant (CMA) designation. HALVERSON reimburses 50% of exam and review course costs for either designation after the employee passes. The staff accountant (judge) has gathered the following information:

	CPA	**CMA**
Exam and application fees	$1,600	$1,700
Review course	$2,200	$1,300
HALVERSON salary increase after earning	$5,400 per year	$4,800 per year
Continuing education required	40 hours per year	30 hours per year

The staff accountant (judge) enjoys analyzing costs and budgets for the company's product lines but has also wondered about working at a public accounting firm someday.

The staff accountant (judge) wants you to:

- Explain the differences between the CPA and CMA designations.
- Calculate the out-of-pocket cost of each designation after reimbursement and how many months of the salary increase it would take to earn that cost back.
- Explain the career opportunities and responsibilities that come with each designation.
- Explain why ongoing education matters after earning a designation.
- Identify skills that would help the staff accountant (judge) advance.

You will present the information to the staff accountant (judge) in a meeting at the office. The staff accountant (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking for advice. After you have presented the information and answered the staff accountant's (judge's) questions, the staff accountant (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. The CMA pays for itself faster. Does that make it the better choice?
2. Besides passing exams, what would make the managers here see me as ready for a promotion?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Discuss professional designations for accountants (e.g., CPA, CMA, CIA, CFE, etc.).	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Identify career opportunities in accounting.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the roles and responsibilities of accounting professionals.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify skills needed to enhance career progression.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Accurate** Demonstrate appropriate finance acumen.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	

Answer key:

- CPA: out of pocket $1,900, earned back in about 4.2 months.
- CMA: out of pocket $1,500, earned back in about 3.75 months.